Spend tracker: walk-through for Raúl and Tereza

Platform data to 12 Oct 2026 · all amounts in USD · page 1: what to say and show · page 2: questions, routine, decisions

Open with this

- **What it is:** one Google Sheet that shows how much of the 2026 paid media budget we've spent, how fast we're spending now and where we land on 31 Dec.
- **Where the numbers come from:** Meta's and Google Ads' own daily exports (each campaign, each day), not the agency's reports. ChatGPT Ads and LinkedIn Ads are typed in when they run.
- **Upkeep:** 3 steps every Monday; everything else updates by itself, with 6 automatic checks.
- **Headline:** at the current pace we end about $3,789 over the $300,000 budget, but $16,211 under the $320,000 maximum.

Spent so far	Current pace	Forecast for 31 Dec	To land on $300,000
$282,524	**$1,861** a week	**$303,789**	**$1,529** a week
94% of the $300,000 budget	last 3 full weeks, 21 Sep – 11 Oct	$3,789 over budget · $16,211 under the maximum	18% less than now

Budget used vs the calendar



We are $48,277 ahead of an even pace ($234,247 by 12 Oct): Q1 and Q2 ran over plan (+$33,496 and +$23,169); every month since August has been under plan.

Show the tabs in this order

left: what it shows · right: what to point out

Tab	What it shows	Point out
1 **Dashboard**	The year on one screen: budget, spent, pace and forecast; budget check; spend by channel, month and quarter; year-end outlook; regions and markets.	Meta $180,767 (64%), Google Ads $101,500 (36%), ChatGPT Ads $257. Red = over budget or over plan; green = within.
2 **Weekly**	Each week (Monday to Sunday): spend by channel against the plan ($5,753 a week), Meta registrations and Google conversions with their cost, notes.	Last full week (5 Oct – 11 Oct): $1,887 (Meta $1,174, Google Ads $713). Agency notes until W/C 5 Oct; mine from W/C 12 Oct.
3 **Monthly**	Each month by channel against the plan, the running total, 'as billed' columns for the invoice check, clicks and conversions with their costs.	Over plan from February to July; under plan every month since August. September: $18,174, $6,484 under plan.
4 **By location**	Spend by region, market and campaign type, read from the location code at the start of each campaign name.	EMEA $141,049 (50%), Americas $127,616 (45%), Global $13,602 (5%). Meta prospecting lead ads and Google Search non-brand are 84% of all spend.
5 **Agency check**	The agency's weekly Notion reports next to the platform exports, week by week (reference only).	Meta matched within $5 in 31 of 33 weeks; Google in only 11 of 32. H1: agency $182,516, platforms $205,432.
6 **Update, Settings, exports**	Update: the Monday routine and 6 checks. Settings: budget, exchange rate, ended campaigns, location codes. Export tabs: the raw data.	All 6 checks pass (data to 12 Oct). Only the yellow cells are ever typed in.

Answers, routine and what to ask

Keep this page open for questions. The last card is how to close the meeting.

If they ask…

Why is 94% spent when 78% of the year has gone?
Q1 and Q2 ran over plan (+$33,496 and +$23,169); every month since August has been under plan. We are still $48,277 ahead of an even pace ($234,247 by 12 Oct).

Why not use the agency's reports?
Meta matched, Google didn't: in 21 of 32 weeks its Google figure was converted to dollars, doubled or lower than the platform, and the July report used £1 = $1.28 on a euro account. H1: agency $182,516, platforms $205,432.

LinkedIn and ChatGPT?
LinkedIn: no spend in 2026. ChatGPT: one 10-day test, €229.56 ($257). Both are typed on 'Other channels' when they run.

Why did spend drop in September?
Budgets were cut: Meta from $310 to $160 a day from 18 Sep, Google on 19 and 21 Sep (agency notes on the Weekly tab). FR_Alibaba stopped on 5 Oct and is left out of the pace.

How do we know it's right?
6 checks on the Update tab: columns found, dates read, both exports end on the same day, every campaign has a market, the exports fit, ended campaigns found (all pass today). Once a month: 'as billed' against the invoices.

How the numbers are calculated

- **USD everywhere.** Meta bills in USD. Google Ads and ChatGPT Ads bill in EUR, converted at 1 EUR = 1.1177 USD (live rate on 13 Oct). Finance's monthly rates can replace it on Settings.
- **Data date** = the last day in both exports (12 Oct).
- **Plan** = the $300,000 spread evenly over the year: $5,753 a week.
- **Current pace** = the last 3 full weeks ÷ 3, leaving out campaigns that ended for good (FR_Alibaba: $2,589 in those weeks; the ChatGPT test). Their spend still counts in 'spent so far'.
- **Forecast** = spent so far + current pace × 11.4 weeks left.
- **Market and campaign type** come from each campaign name. A new location code is added once on Settings → Locations; the Update tab flags any spend without a market.

Every Monday the Update tab, 3 steps

1. Meta Ads Manager → campaigns by day, 1 Jan to yesterday → .csv → 'Meta export' tab: replace the data.
2. Google Ads → saved spend report, 1 Jan to yesterday → .csv → 'Google export' tab: replace the data.
3. Update tab says 'All good' (6 checks) → 1–2 lines on last week in the Weekly notes (launches, pauses, budget changes).

Only when needed: ChatGPT or LinkedIn spend (Other channels); an ended campaign, a new location code or Finance's rates (Settings). **First Monday of the month:** 'as billed' against the invoices. The weekly paid report uses the same two exports.

Close with: what we need from you

1. **FR_Alibaba:** Does it count toward this budget? Meta campaign run by Plug and Play's internal team: $4,491 from 10 Sep to 5 Oct.
2. **ChatGPT Ads:** Does it count? The 10-day test, 23 Sep – 2 Oct: €229.56 ($257).
3. **Year-end target:** Land on $300,000 (≈ $1,529 a week, 18% less than now) or keep the current pace (≈ $303,789, inside the $320,000 maximum)?
4. **Exchange rate:** Keep 1.1177 or use Finance's monthly rates?
5. **2027:** What is the 2027 budget, and when will it be confirmed?

If we spend from now on…	Per week	31 Dec	vs budget	vs maximum
…at the current pace	**$1,861**	**$303,789**	**+$3,789**	**−$16,211**
…to land on the budget	$1,529	$300,000	$0	−$20,000
…to use the maximum	$3,279	$320,000	+$20,000	$0

11.4 weeks left to 31 Dec. The Dashboard's "Year-end outlook" shows the same figures.